

Vu Vibe DV

A balanced QLED TV under ₹35,000

₹34,990

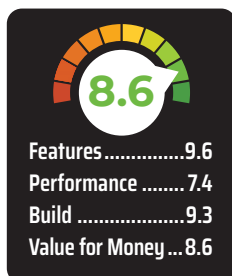


The Vu Vibe DV came to us for testing during the Digit Zero1 awards season last year. But since QLED TVs weren't a category in the awards, it couldn't participate. That said, over the months, we have used this TV a lot, and so I thought it deserves to be reviewed for the value it brings to the board. Vu launched the 55-inch model of this TV at Rs 36,999, and currently, it is available for Rs 34,990. And for that asking price, it brings a 4K HDR panel with Dolby Vision, HDR10, Google TV OS, a dedicated Game mode, and gaming features like VRR and ALLM.

Surely, the specs sound quite promising on paper, but the real question lies: how do they translate in real-world use? And so, should you invest in this 55-inch Vu Vibe DV QLED TV?

DISPLAY AND AUDIO

The Vibe DV uses a VA QLED panel with 4K resolution and support for HDR formats like Dolby Vision,



HDR10, and HLG. The TV comes in multiple screen sizes: 43-inch, 50-inch, 55-inch and 65-inch. We have reviewed the 55-inch model. In our internal test, the TV projected 343.8 nits of brightness (close to the claimed 400 nits peak) and 0.06 nits of black level, which gives about 5730:1 contrast ratio. That is not very high, but the results were clear and sufficiently detailed for a value midrange QLED panel. While watching Mission Impossible: The Final Reckoning's underwater submarine scene, a favourite test scenario of mine, everything was legible on this panel.

Colours are likeable but not very natural. The BT 709 colour gamut coverage measured around 91.4%, which results in an enjoyable SDR playback for YouTube, cable channels, and streaming content. As for HDR, the panel covered 69.54% in the BT 2020 gamut and 94.17% in UHDA-P3 coverage. Respectable numbers and in Filmmaker Mode, the skin tones and overall colours look

slightly washed out, but the dark scenes and portions carry discernible details.

When it comes to motion handling, you can enable MEMC for smoother visuals in soap operas and sports, but in movies and web series, I suggest you disable this for a more original cinematic frame rate.

In case of games, the TV supports Game Mode, Auto Low Latency Mode (ALLM), and Variable Refresh Rate (VRR) through HDMI 2.1. But since the native refresh rate is 60Hz only, things like VRR are limited. So, you can have casual gaming. That's it.

On the audio front, HDMI-based eARC and ARC are available. But the headline feature is the integrated 88W soundbar with Dolby Atmos support. The system uses a 4.1-channel equivalent setup with two main speakers and two dedicated tweeters. This delivers good front-firing sound with clear enough vocals, dialogues and fine overall output. Since you sit in front of the TV, that matters to some extent. But, when compared against a comparably priced Lumio Vision 7, this one comes second in loudness and overall quality.

SOFTWARE INTERFACE

Vu Vibe DV is powered by a 1.5GHz quad-core VuOn AI processor paired with a Mali-450 GPU. It comes with 2GB RAM and 16GB internal storage.

On top of this, you get Google TV based on Android 12 with the December 2024 security patch. Considering some of its rivals are giving Android 14, this seems a bit dated under the hood. But, on the surface, the Google TV UI is quite familiar and easy to use, even for a new user. Google's operating system organises content well across different streaming platforms instead of forcing users to jump between apps constantly.

The everyday performance is largely smooth with occasional expected lags and micro-stutters. This is apparent in the time it takes to load all thumbnails on the homescreen after a cold boot. Overall, the navigation across menus and apps feels responsive enough.